



MANGAL ANALYTICS AND
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MARC Insights **The Rise in Destination Weddings and its Impact on Hotels**

April 2026



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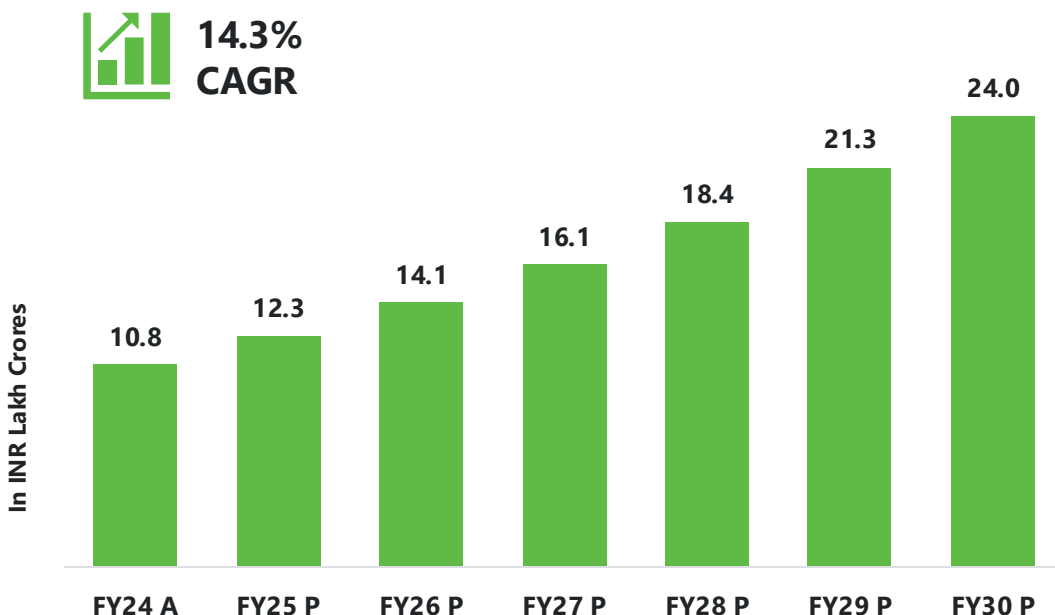
Overview of emerging trends and venue preferences in the market

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Destination Wedding Market Overview

India's Wedding Market Overview

India's Wedding Market Size



The industry supports an estimated 10 million jobs across hospitality, event management, logistics, and fashion. More powerfully: the 45-day peak wedding season injects INR 6 to 6.5 lakh crore into the economy equivalent to roughly 1.91% of India's entire annual GDP, making weddings India's fourth-largest industry, larger than the aviation market. Also, Indian families spend, on average, twice as much on a single wedding as they do on 18 years of their child's education.

Source: [Grand View Research](#), [Wedmegood Report](#), [Per Capita](#), [Kotak Wedding Industry](#), [kotakmf](#), [chococraft](#)

Why the Market Will Blow Past INR 24 Lakh Crore



The Sheer Scale

470 million Indians are currently in the marriageable age bracket. This demographic pipeline is what makes the next decade's growth structurally inevitable, not just aspirational.



The Spend Escalation

On average, weddings got 7% more expensive in 2024 versus 2023, primarily due to hospitality and venue pricing rising by over 10%, meaning the industry is inflating faster than general consumer prices



The Celebrations Are Getting Longer and Bigger

Average guest size at Indian weddings grew 14.8% from 270 guests in FY23 to 310 guests in FY24. The average number of wedding ceremonies such as Mehendi, Sangeet, and Reception, rose from 3.2 to 4.2 over the same period. Longer celebrations mean more room nights, more F&B, more ancillary hotel revenue.

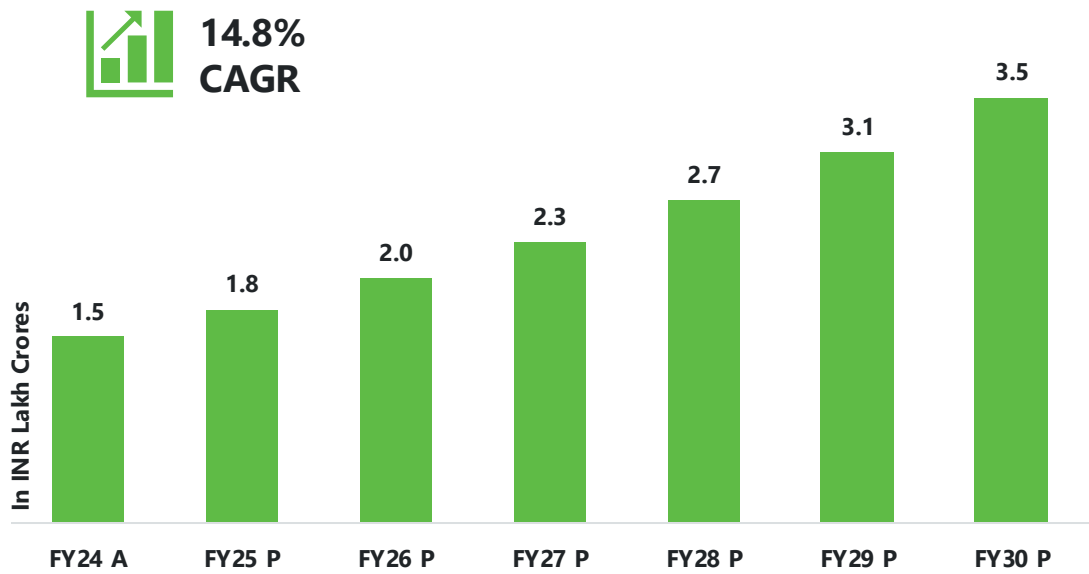


The Government Tailwind

The "Wed in India" campaign aims to retain INR 1.1 Lakh Crores within the country annually, with the Ministry of Tourism actively showcasing 25 key destinations across Beach, Nature, Royal, and Himalayan themes to position India as a global wedding destination.

Indian Destination Wedding Market Size

India's Destination Wedding Market Size



The India destination wedding market size was estimated at INR 1.5 Lakhs Crores in FY24 and is projected to reach INR 3.5 Lakhs Crores by FY30, growing at a CAGR of 14.8%. The demand for destination weddings in India has seen an impressive uptrend in recent years, shaped by a blend of rising consumer affluence, aspirational lifestyles, and evolving expectations around marriage ceremonies. Increasingly, Indian couples are moving away from traditional hometown weddings in favor of immersive, curated experiences at picturesque locations.

Source: [Grand View Research](#), [Wedmegood Report](#)

Key Growth Drivers



The Generational Shift

85% of Indians surveyed are either planning or have already had a destination wedding, with Gen Z leading sharply, 49% of Gen Z couples are considering a destination wedding compared to just 33% of Millennials. The trend is accelerating, not plateauing.



The Premium Surge

Almost 9% of Indian weddings now have a budget of over INR 1 crore, and more than 60% of those INR 1 crore+ weddings are planned as destination weddings.



The Willingness to Splurge

Over 26% of millennials who plan to self-fund their wedding would consider taking a personal loan to do so, showing that spending intent outpaces even available savings, making demand exceptionally resilient to economic softness.



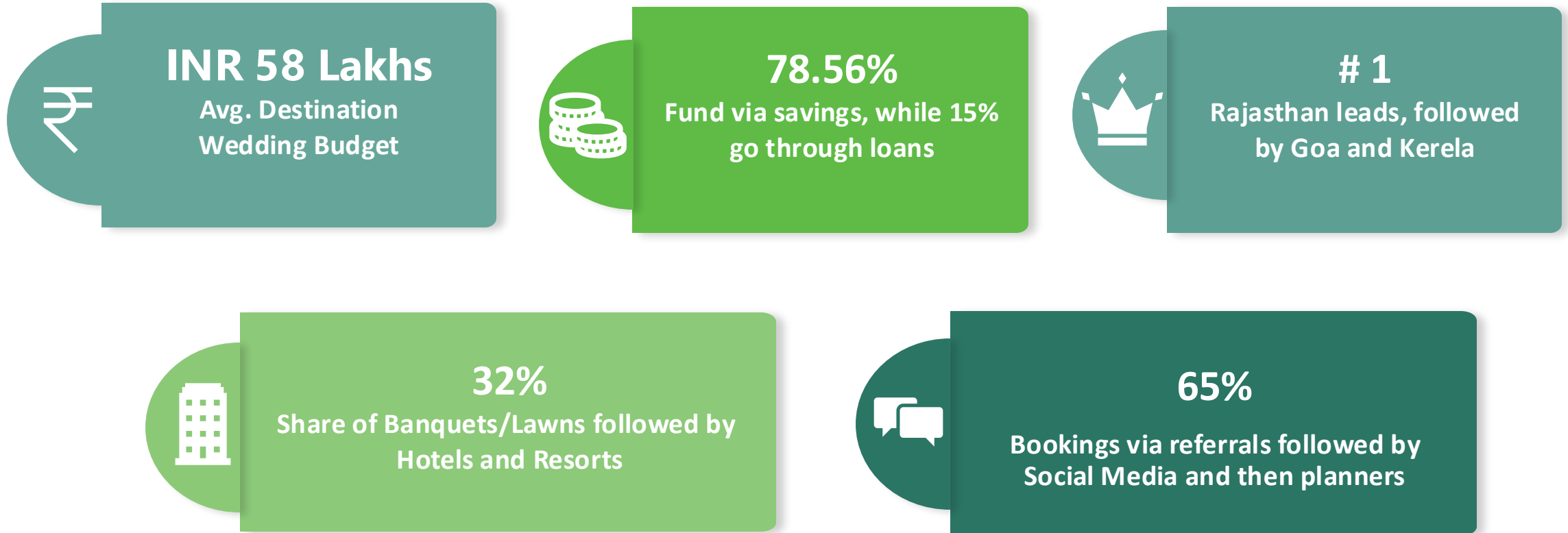
The Digital Paradox

83.2% of couples now use wedding planning platforms like WedMeGood or WeddingWire for research, yet 75 to 87% of all vendor bookings are still completed offline, showing the massive digitization opportunity that remains untapped.

Market Dynamics, Key Geographies & Industry Players

From Budget To Booking, How Decisions Actually Get Made

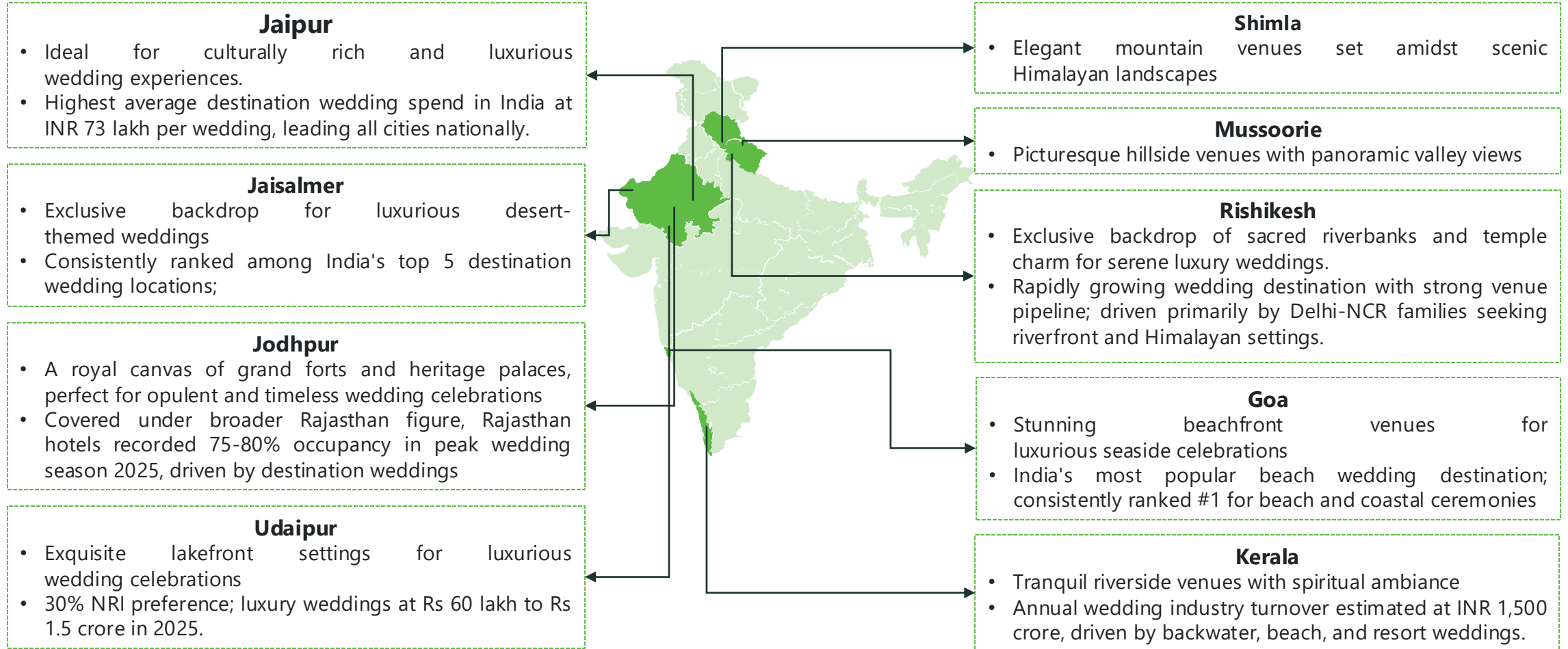
"Indian couples spend more than ever, borrow to do it, choose destination weddings for the experience, and still book through someone they trust."



Source: wedmegood

Top Wedding Destination Locations In India

According to WeddingWire India (2025), the cost of destination weddings in India ranges from **INR 25 lakhs to INR 1.2 crore**, depending on location, scale, and luxury preferences.



Source: [Destination Wedding India](#), [Varniya](#), [udaipurtimes](#), [marknteladvisors](#), [newindianexpress](#)

Upcoming Hotspots for Destination Weddings

As per Grand View Research "45% of couples are willing to increase their budgets by 50% specifically to secure unique, unforgettable weddings at lesser-known locales like Gokarna and Mahabalipuram."

Gokarna



Gokarna offers pristine beaches and boutique venues, making it ideal for relaxed, intimate, bohemian-style weddings.

Mahabalipuram



This UNESCO World Heritage Site town blends heritage architecture with seaside beauty, offering weddings at ancient temples or luxury resorts by the Bay of Bengal.

Kalimpong



Kalimpong offers a serene Himalayan setting with heritage charm and scenic views, ideal for intimate weddings away from tourist crowds.

Kukas Village



Kukas offers boutique and heritage-style venues with Rajasthani charm, ideal for private, royal-style weddings away from crowds.

Source: [Outlook Traveller GVR](#)

Players in the Destination Wedding Industry



Partners	Client-driven and project-specific	Project Based Collaboration	Accor, Marriott, Taj, Oberoi, Hyatt, Hilton	Project Based Collaboration	Radisson, Royal Orchid, Holiday Inn, ITC, Belle Monde
Presence (Geography)	PAN India, International	PAN India, Global	Worldwide (London, Dubai, etc)	India/ Europe Focus	25+ Cities+ 20,000 Wedding Venues
Expertise	Bespoke Décor Themes	Contemporary Logistics	NRI Turnkey, Vendor Networks	Entertainment, Cultural	Venue/ Tech Coordination
Market Position	Luxury Leader	Mid-Premium Riser	Top Logistics Player	Niche Luxury Specialist	Volume/ Market Share Leader
Experience	Est. 2009 15+ Years Expertise	Est. 2015 10+ Years Expertise	Since 2006 15+ Years Experience	Est. 2013 10+ Years Expertise	Since 2015 10+ Years Experience
Competitive Edge	Widest international destination reach	Celebrity destination wedding specialist	Offices across India, Middle East, UK, UAE & Canada	Bollywood's preferred planner	Tech-led venue network across Goa, Udaipur & Jaipur

Source: [Tamarind Global](#), [Economic Times](#)

Impact on Hotels

How Destination Weddings Are Helping Hotels



Source: [Business India](#), [Travel Trends Today](#)

Impact on Hotels

Hotel growth

Hotels project 8–10% growth in 2026, led specifically by destination weddings in Tier-II and Tier-III cities.

Per-guest spending behaviour

15 – 20% increase in thematic entries, handcrafted menus, and regional culinary experiences, all contributing to higher per-guest spends at hotel-hosted destination weddings.

Occupancy

Wedding season drives hotel occupancy rates to 70–72% nationally.

Multi – day stays

Nationally, 35% of couples planned three-day wedding, with 25% opting for two-day celebrations. Together, these two stats explain why destination weddings are so valuable to hotels

ARR

As per ICRA ARR for premium hotels are projected to rise to INR 8,200 to 8,500 in FY26, after INR 8,000 to 8,200 in FY25

Source: [businessstandard](https://www.businessstandard.com), [desimetros.com](https://www.desimetros.com)



Hotel Testimonials

- Fairmont Jaipur reported a 25% rise in bookings year-on-year, while Rambagh Palace Jaipur recorded its highest-ever ARR, with INR 1 lakh per room rates. Normally only seen at Christmas and New Year is now being achieved weeks earlier purely due to wedding demand.
- Radisson Hotel Group reported an 87.1% year-on-year rise in wedding segment room revenue, supported by a 46% rise in room nights booked and a 28% increase in average daily rate, all specifically from the wedding segment.
- Nikhil Sharma, MD and Area Senior VP for South Asia at Radisson, confirmed that the October–December 2024 quarter set a new record as the highest revenue-generating period in the company's entire South Asia history, with resort properties in Mamallapuram, Lonavala, Karjat, and Udaipur already sold out on multiple dates due to destination wedding demand.
- Raj Chopra, Chairman and MD of JW Marriott Mussoorie and JW Marriott Goa, also reported the highest-ever bookings and sales for weddings at both properties.

Source: [businessstandard](#), [desimetros.com](#) [business-standard](#)





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